



A National Overview of College Based Transition Services

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NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER

Our conversation

- Background on Legislation
- TPSIDs and CTPs (oh goodie, new acronyms!!)
- Current research and practice
- **Inclusive** Higher Education



The TPSID National Coordinating Center at Think College is a project of the Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston.

The Center is funded by the Office of Postsecondary Education Grant #P407B140002.





Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.

Think College is a national organization dedicated to developing, expanding, and improving research and practice in inclusive higher education for people with intellectual disability.

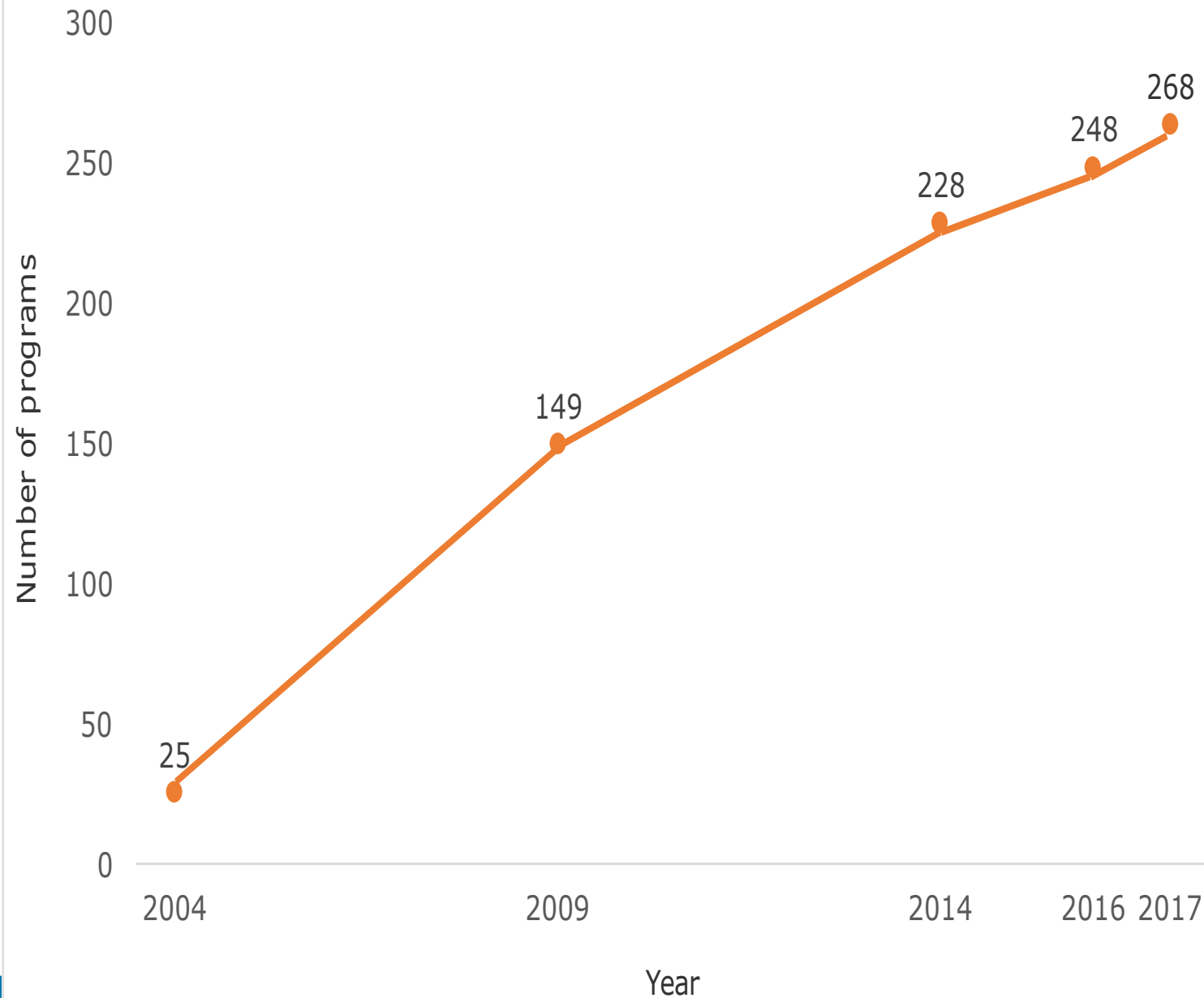
www.ThinkCollege.net

The Think College website is a trusted source for information, training, and resources related to inclusive higher education for students with intellectual disability. The website includes:

- A searchable program directory to learn more about available college options
- A resource library that includes published research as well as field-created tools and resources
- Online learning modules on a variety of topics
- Research to practice briefs, e-newsletters, and journal articles
- Topical information on the critical issues
- A policy and legislation clearinghouse

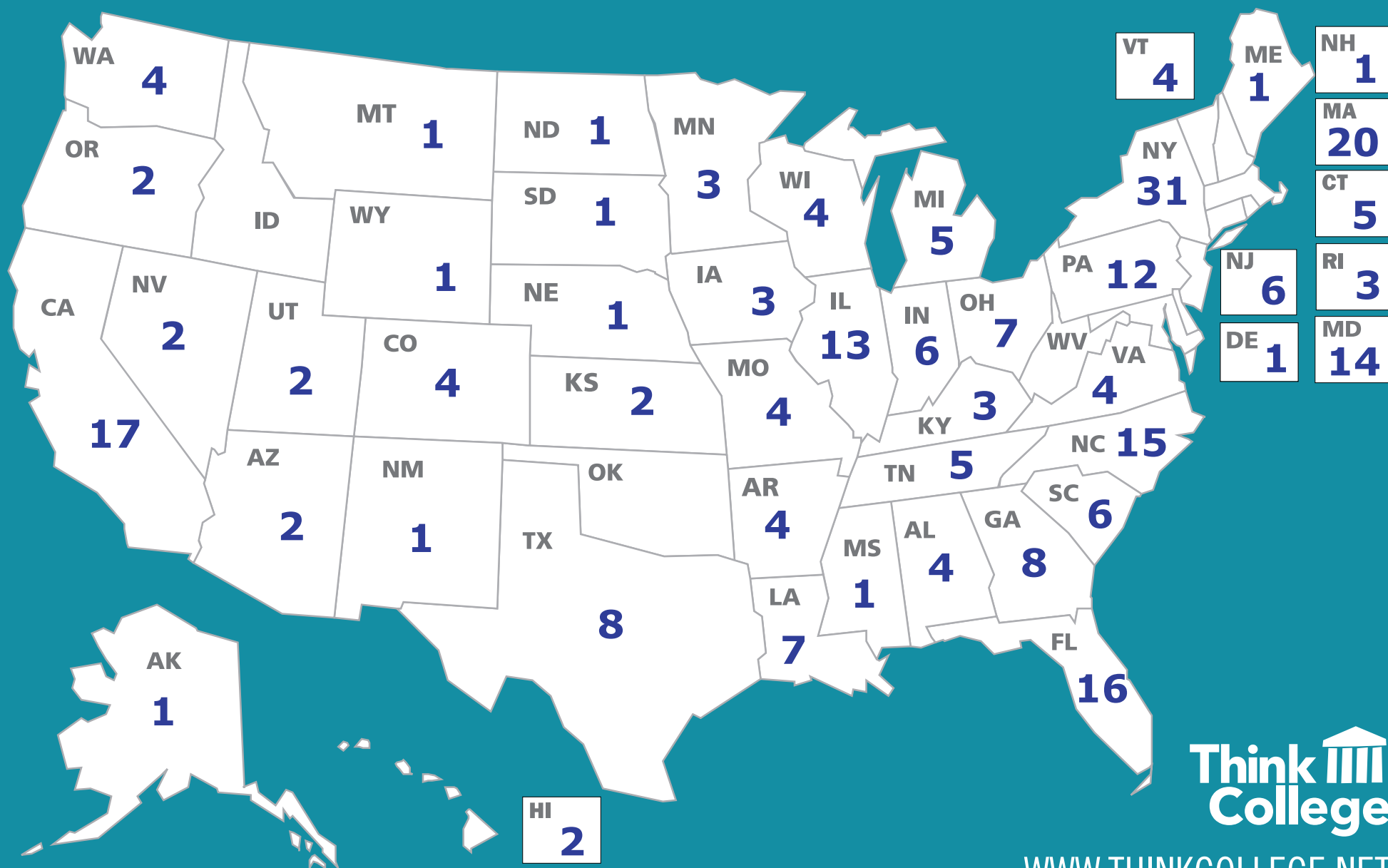


Growth in Postsecondary Education Programs in the U.S.



COLLEGE OPTIONS FOR PEOPLE WITH INTELLECTUAL DISABILITIES, SEPT. 2017

TOTAL NUMBER OF PROGRAMS: 268



Think College

WWW.THINKCOLLEGE.NET

Things to consider

- What has impacted this growth in higher education?
- What can higher education programs offer students with ID
- How does it impact our approach to college based transition plans?



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So how do we begin?

Let's start with the law.....



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Higher Education Opportunity Act of 2008 (HEOA) Provisions Related to Students with Intellectual Disability (ID)

- **Model Demonstration Programs:** Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability (TPSIDs) authorized to enable institutions of higher education (IHEs) to create or expand high-quality inclusive programs for students with ID.
- **National Coordinating Center (NCC):** Authorized to provide technical assistance, coordination between and evaluation of TPSID projects, and create recommended model standards for programs through an Accreditation Workgroup.
- **Federal Student Aid:** Eligibility for Pell grants, Federal Supplemental Educational Opportunity Grants and Work-Study jobs.



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What is a CTP?

- Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary (CTP) Program
- Pathway to Title IV (i.e., federal) financial aid for students with intellectual disability (ID)
- Traditional requirements for accessing Title IV financial aid:
 - Required to be working toward a degree or certificate
 - Required to have a high school diploma, GED, or have passed an ability-to-benefit test

CTP removes these barriers
for students with ID



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<https://thinkcollege.net/resources/innovation-exchange/paying-for-college>



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Definition in HEOA:

A student—

“(A) with intellectual disability characterized by significant limitations in—

“(i) intellectual and cognitive functioning; and

“(ii) adaptive behavior as expressed in conceptual, social, and practical adaptive skills; and

“(B) who is currently, or was formerly, eligible for a free appropriate public education under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act.

Categories of College Programs

- Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities
 - Model Demonstration projects funded by the US Department of Education, Office of Postsecondary Education
- Comprehensive Transition Programs
 - Programs that have been through an approval process and can offer access to federal financial aid
- College-based Transition Program



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What have we learned from the TPSIDs

<https://thinkcollege.net/tpsid>



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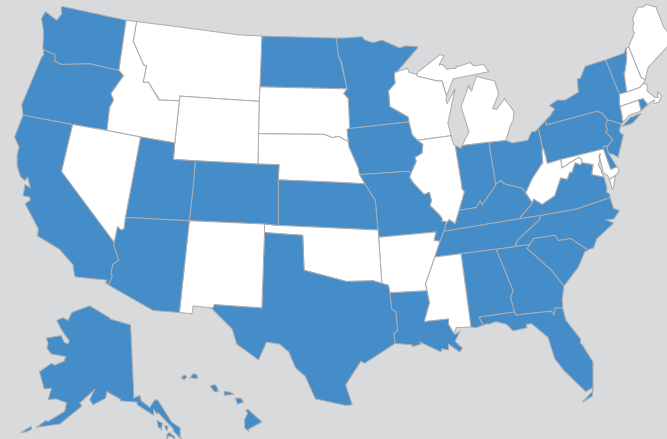


TPSID COHORT 1 & 2 (2010–2016)

More than 2,700 students served

88 **CAMPUSES** 

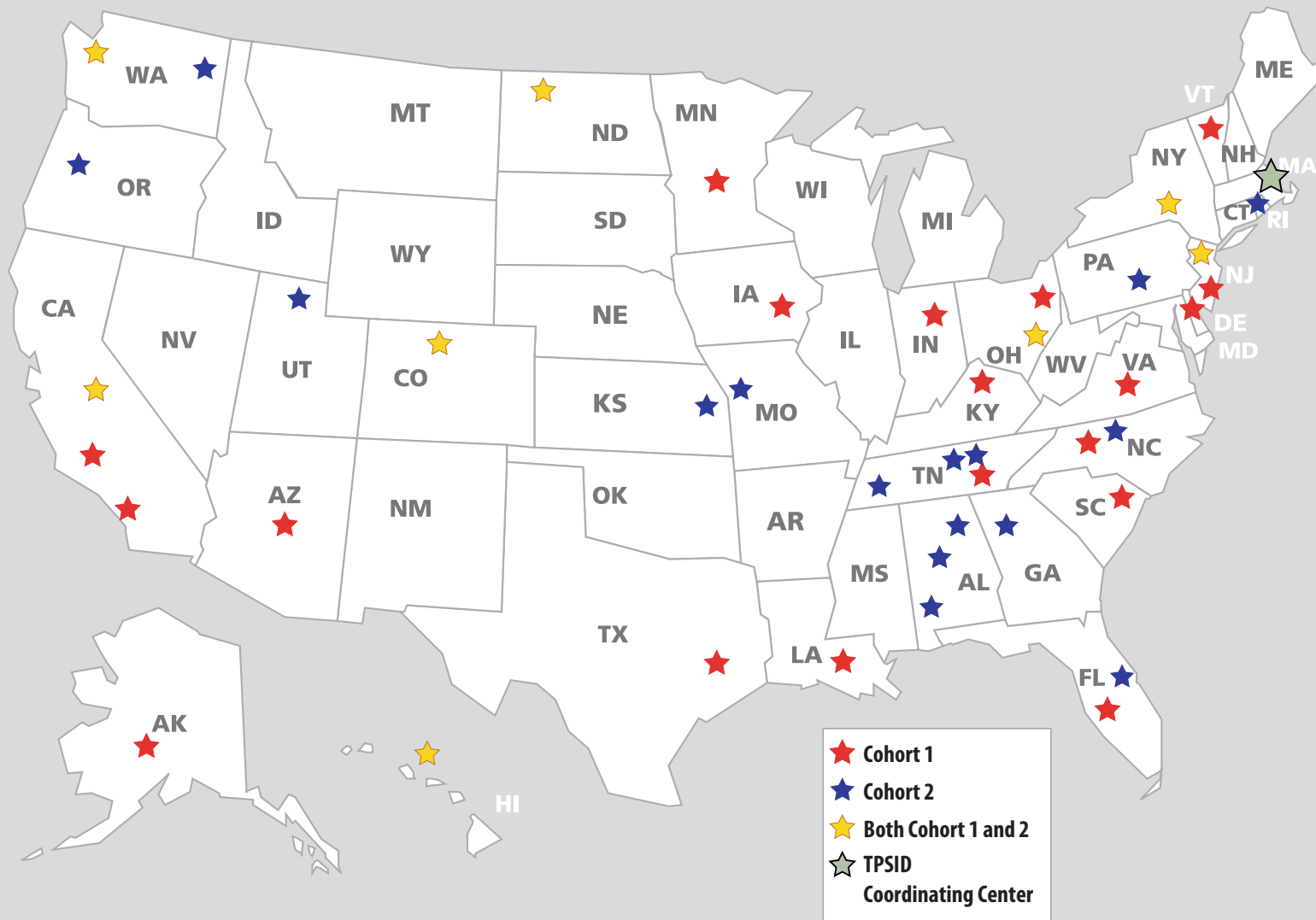
31 STATES



Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.



TPSID 2010-2020 GRANTEES



TPSID Cohort 1 & 2 Trend Data (2010–2016)

Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.



Key Outcomes from TPSID Cohort 1

- 2,245 students attended programs at 57 college and university campuses implementing 27 model demonstration grants
- Students enrolled in over 10,000 inclusive courses
- 846 students worked in a paid job while also attending the program
- Students held a total of 1,668 different jobs
- Of these, 1,496 (67%) had exited by the end of the 5-year funding period.
- Of the students employed at exit, 90% were in jobs that are integrated and in the competitive labor market



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PROGRAMS



- 25** grantees
- 44** Institutes of Higher Education (IHEs)
- 10** 2-year IHEs
- 34** 4-year IHEs
- 12** Comprehensive Transition Programs
- 15** serve transition-aged high school students

2015-2016 Data from TPSID Cohort 2 sites

STUDENTS

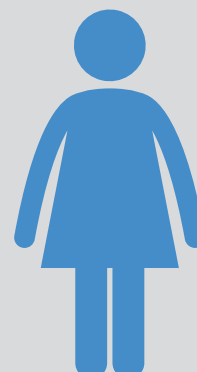


449
STUDENTS

MEDIAN AGE=20

STUDENT AGES RANGED FROM 16—42

59%
MALE



41%
FEMALE

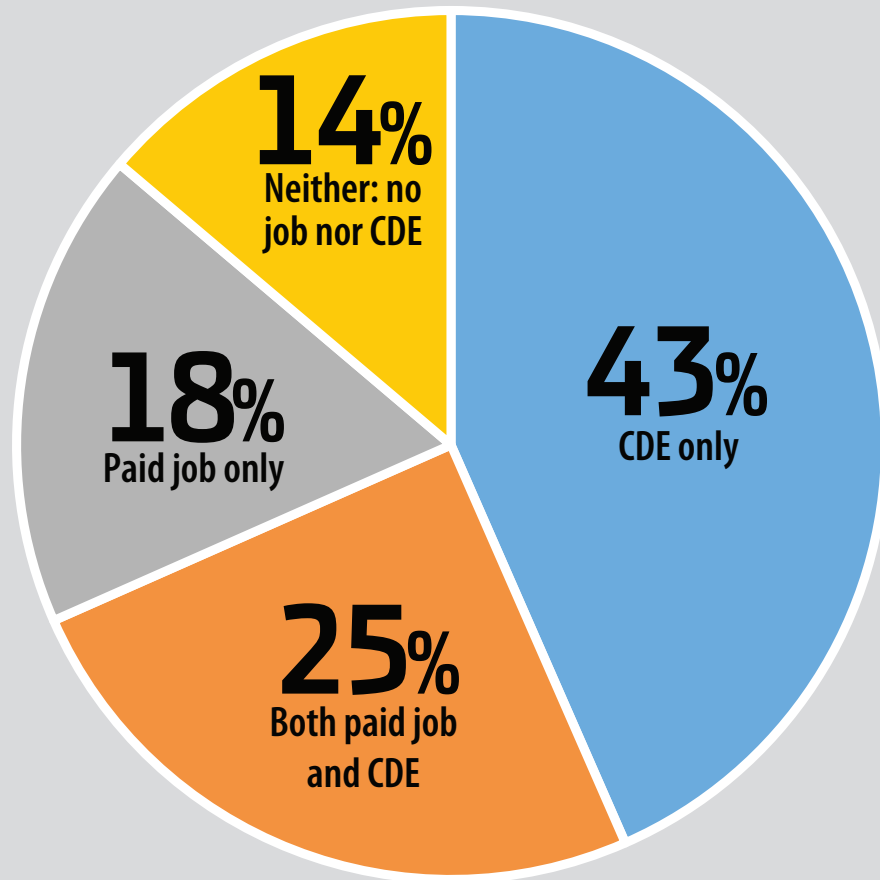
31%: percentage of students who were receiving
special education services under IDEA.

2015-2016 Data from TPSID Cohort 2 sites

EMPLOYMENT



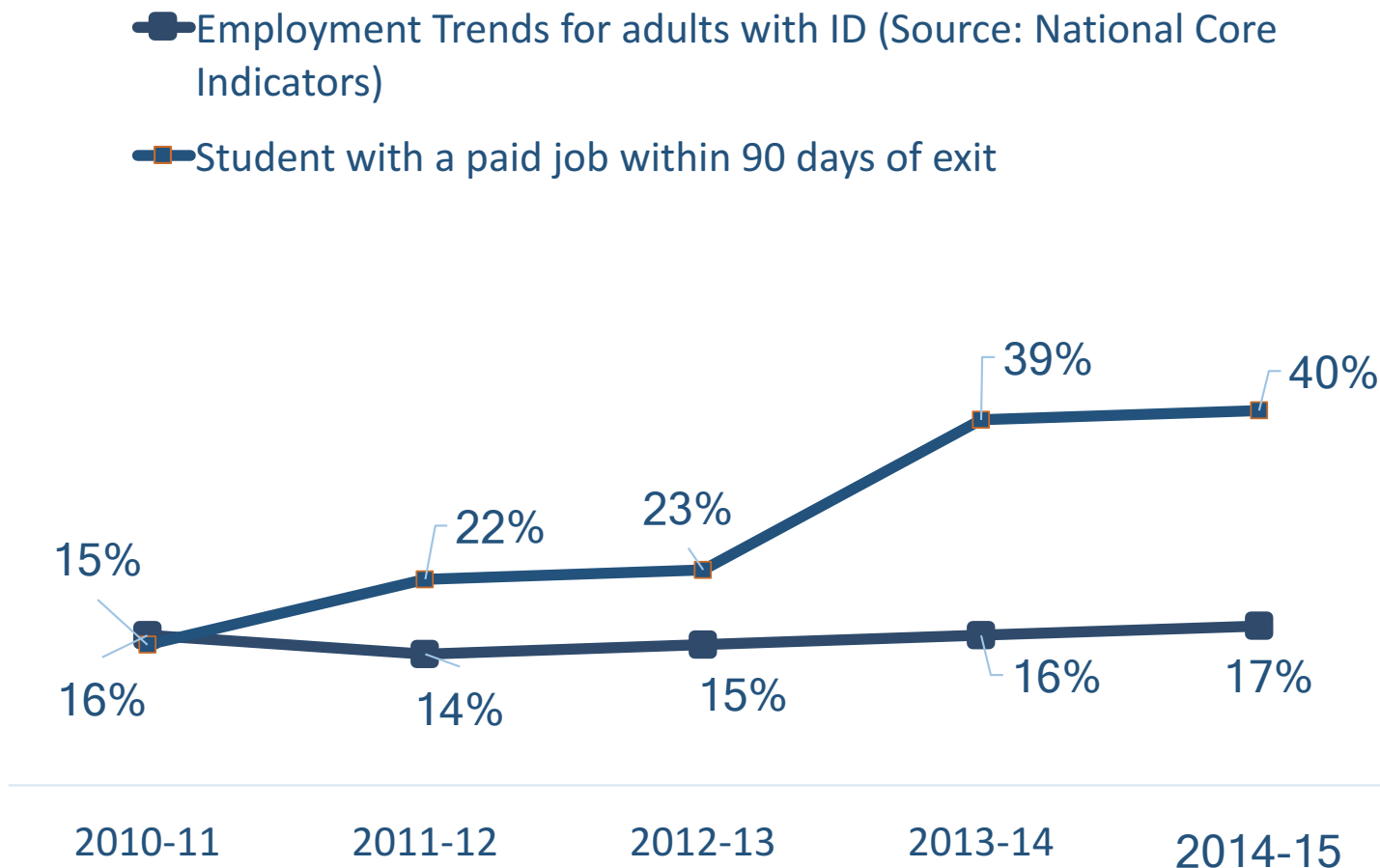
Career Development and Employment in 2015–16



56%
of employed students
had **NEVER** held
a paid job prior to
enrolling in the TPSID

2015-2016 Data from TPSID Cohort 2 sites

Paid Employment at Exit Trends



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ACADEMICS



3

Average number
academically inclusive
courses students
enrolled in per year

60%

Percentage of
students who received
accommodations or
supports from the
disability services office

Students who attended
programs that were
more inclusive were
significantly more likely
to have a paid job while
in the program than
students who attended
less inclusive programs.

(54.2% vs. 39.1%, $p = .002$)

2015-2016 Data from TPSID Cohort 2 sites

What do the TPSIDs tell us about college-based transition services?

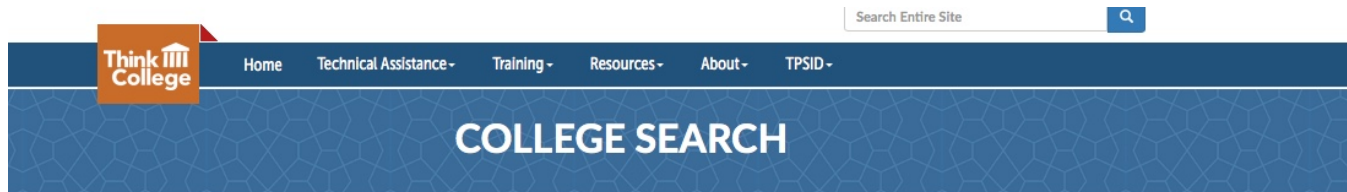
- In the TPSID model demos, from 2010-2015, 25% of students were still receiving special education transition services from a public school system while attending the TPSID program.
- Students at two-year IHEs were less likely to be dually enrolled than those at four-year IHEs (10% versus 30%).
- TPSID Students who were dually enrolled in high school and college in their final year were more likely to exit their program with a paid job than students who were enrolled as an adult student. (41% vs 34%)
- More likely to be served in programs that partner with VR



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<https://thinkcollege.net/college-search>



Think College Search

SAVED

Click the "Save" Button to add a program to this list.

SEARCH

Program or Keyword

LOCATION

☐ Alabama (4)

☐ Alaska (1)

☐ Arizona (2)

☒ Show more states

PROGRAM FEATURES

☐ Serves Students in High School *

☐ Offers Financial Aid

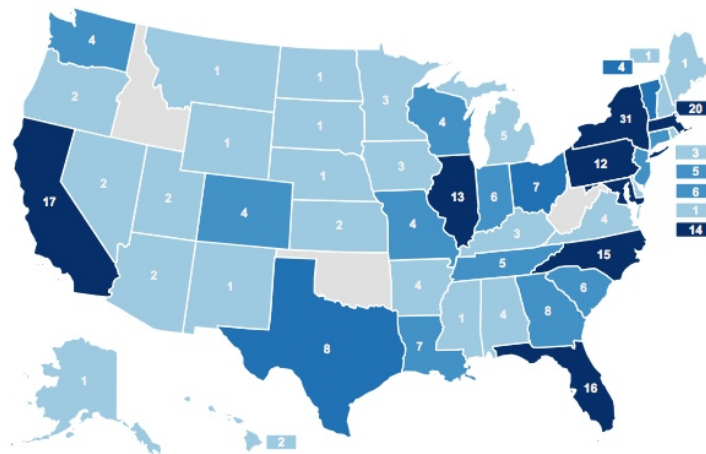
☐ Offers Housing

*Note that students who are dually enrolled might not be eligible for financial aid or housing

Find the college that's right for you!

Find and compare information on 268 college programs for students with intellectual disabilities! Search by program name, location, and other keywords. See "Advanced Filters" for more options to help you narrow your search and build a list of schools that are a good match for you.

Once you have located colleges you are interested in, download the [How To Think College Guide to Conducting a College Search \(PDF\)](#). It provides you with the right questions to ask in order to get the answers you need about each program on your list.



The information included here was submitted to Think College by the college programs. Being listed here does not indicate or imply a Think College endorsement. There also may be programs available that have not reported to us. All programs listed here must be affiliated with an accredited college or university and serve students with intellectual disabilities. To let us know about a new program, or to make changes to a current program listing, please email thinkcollege@umb.edu.

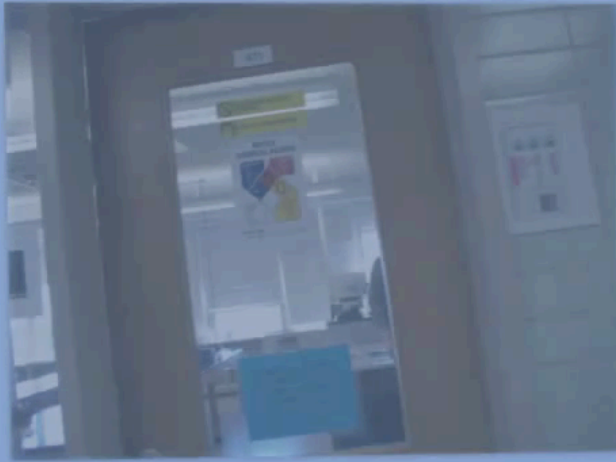
34% or 95/268 programs offer access to transition-aged youth in the Think College national program directory



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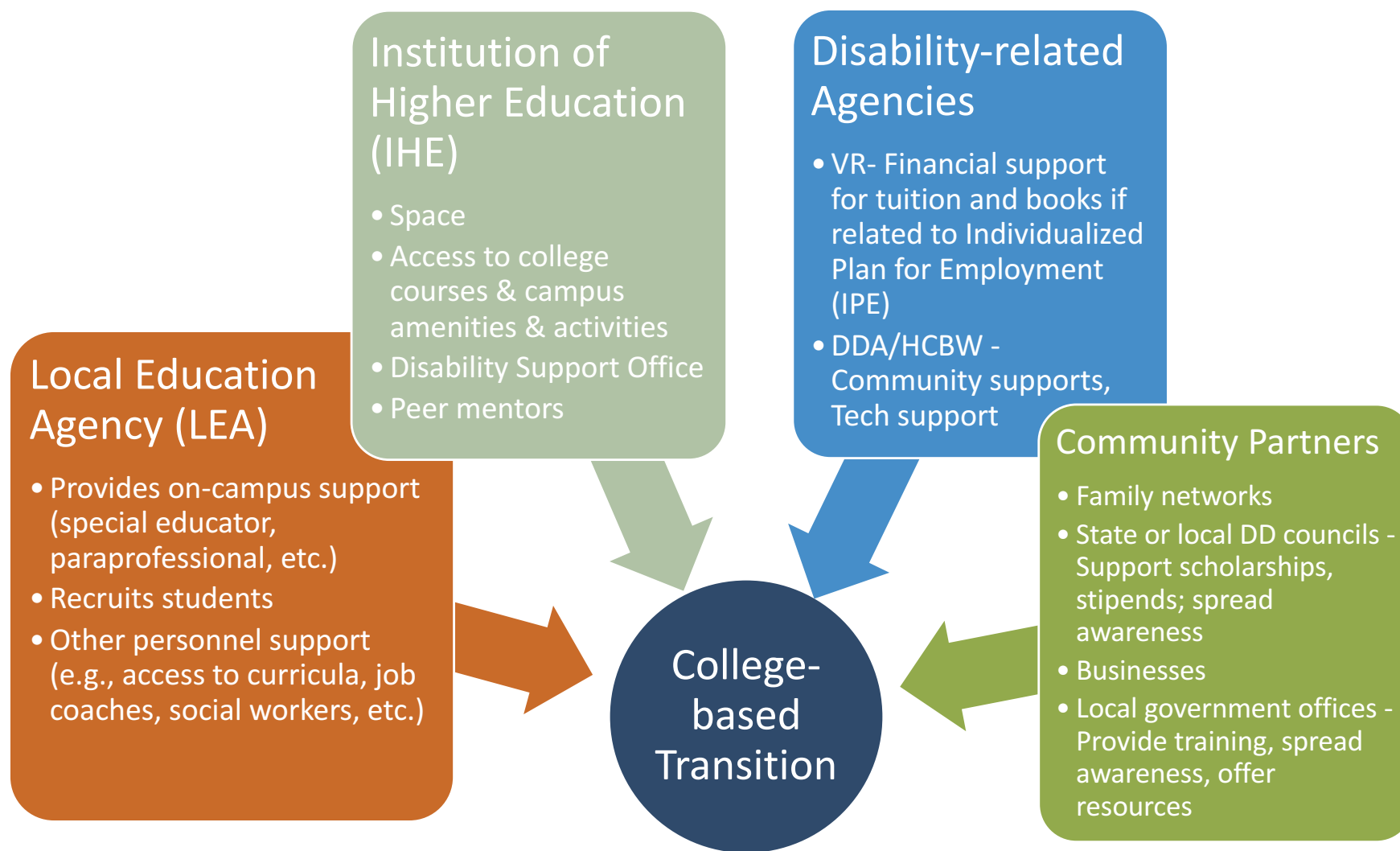
What does it look like?



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Think College Transition Model for Inclusive Dual Enrollment

DRIVEN BY
COLLABORATION

Driven by Collaboration

- Interagency communication
- Mutual outreach efforts
- Evaluation of transition services

TCT Model Components

PLAN

- Person centered planning
- Inclusive course access
- Internships/employment
- Inclusive campus activities

SUPPORT

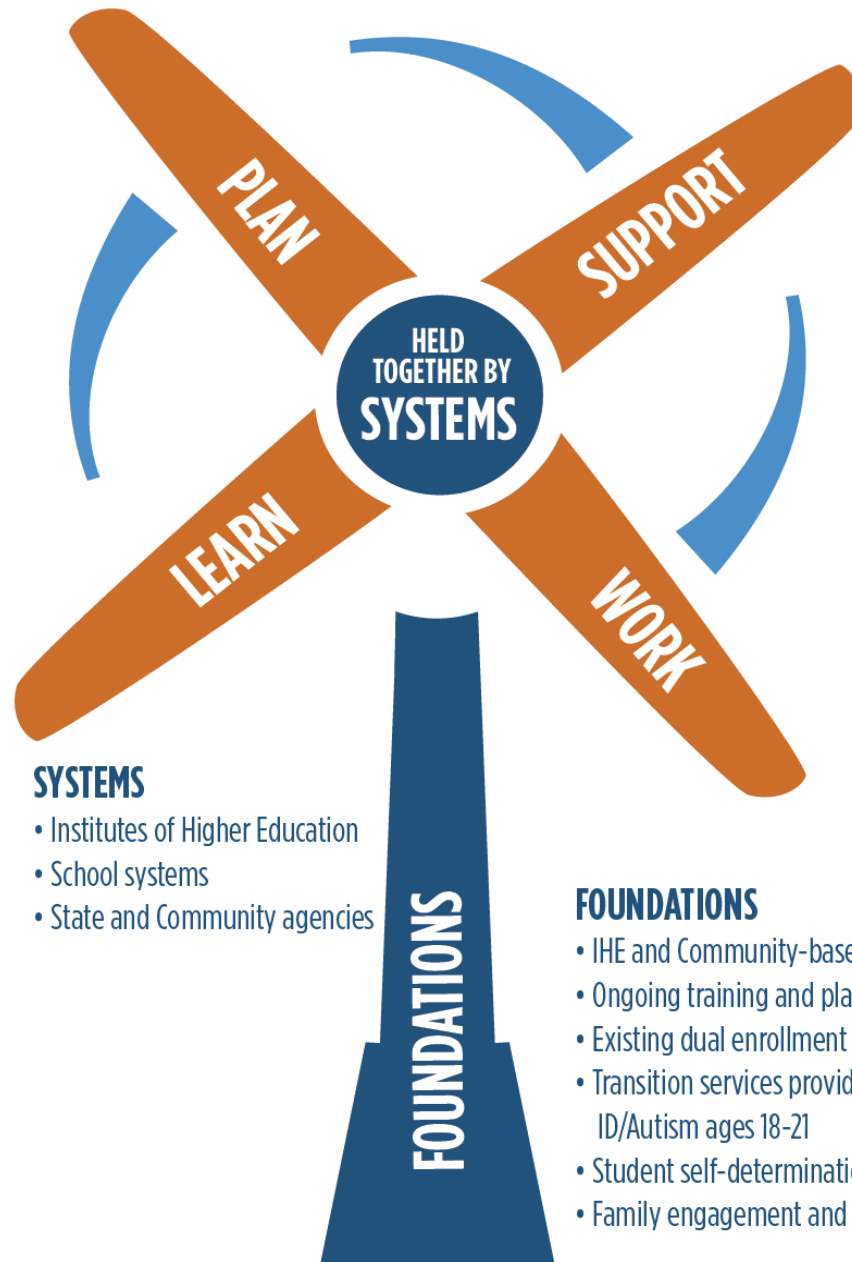
- Disability services
- Peer mentor/educational coach
- Career & Employment supports

WORK

- Integrated competitive employment
- Paid internships
- Work-based learning plan

LEARN

- Priority registration
- Courses identified in PCP
- Courses related to employment goals



FOUNDATIONS

- IHE and Community-based transition services
- Ongoing training and planning
- Existing dual enrollment partnership
- Transition services provided to students with ID/Autism ages 18-21
- Student self-determination and self-advocacy
- Family engagement and partnerships

Lessons Learned

- Need clearly articulated outcomes related to course access and employment
- Need informed and engaged administrators in both higher education and LEAs
- This is a first step, not a last step in college
- Without clear employment goals students won't have good outcomes
- Continually assess if you are meeting your goals and address potential needed changes



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*Want to learn
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www.thinkcollege.net

*Need Advice?
Think College
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thinkcollegeTA@gmail.com



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It's all about expectations.....



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